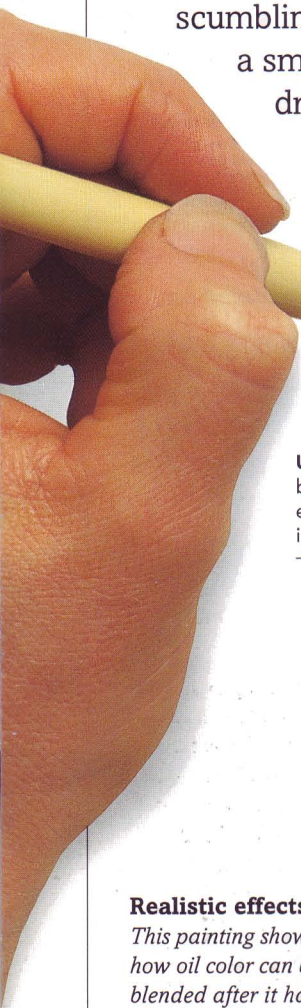


BLENDING & DRY BRUSH

OIL PAINT IS ONE of the most adaptable painting mediums, and you can create many effects with it. There are several techniques for manipulating paint on a surface with a brush; blending, dry brush and scumbling, glazing, and impasto. Blending creates a smooth transition between colors, while dry brush and scumbling break up the colors to give texture.



Use a clean, dry brush to blend separate colors. Make each gentle brushstroke in the same direction.



Smooth objects

The hard, polished appearance and smoothly-rounded surface of this cup are accentuated by careful blending.

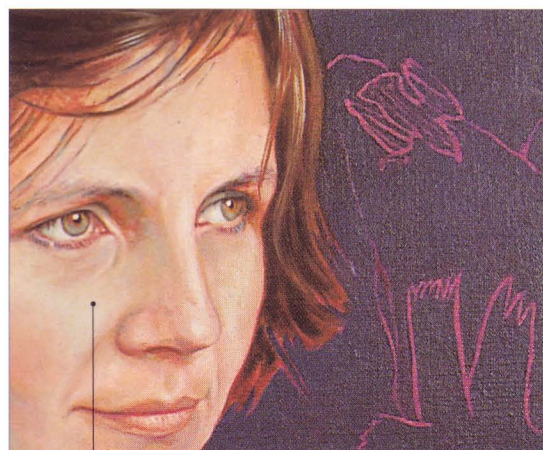
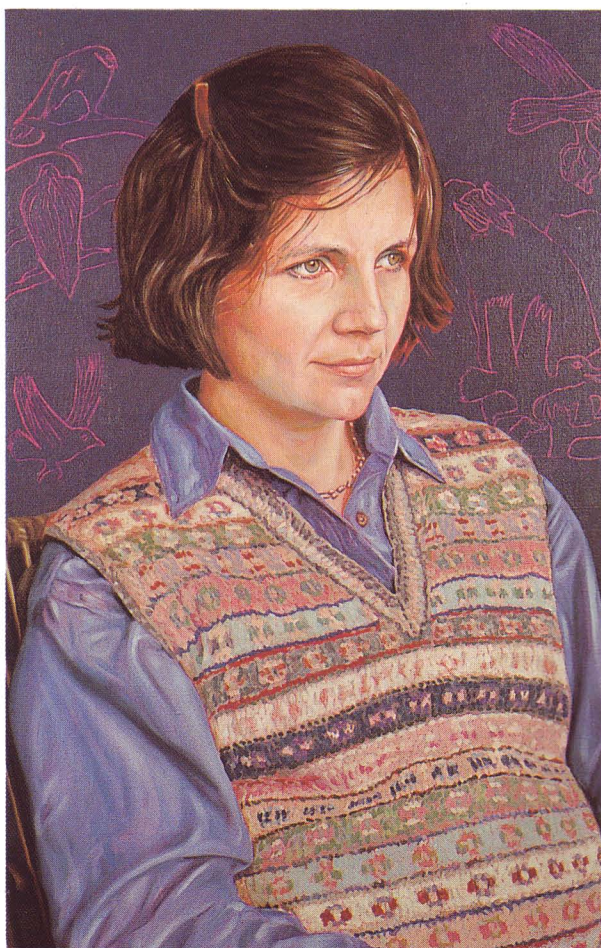


Blending

One feature that distinguishes oil paint from other painting media is its ability to be blended. Separate tones and colors can be painted onto a surface adjacent to one another and then blended by stroking a clean brush down the join between them. Blending may involve slightly softening the sharp outline of an object against a background, or working on a whole painting so that it takes on a rounded, seemingly three-dimensional effect. Use soft hair brushes for small-scale work and bristle brushes for large areas.

Realistic effects

This painting shows how oil color can be blended after it has been applied to a surface. The features of this woman's face have been modeled to give a subtle effect, shown by the smooth tonal change between the highlight on her left cheek through to her hairline and the smooth gradation of tone in her shirt sleeve. Tiny areas, such as the iris in the eye, also rely on smooth transitions between separate areas of color.



Both large and small areas of color in this painting have been blended smoothly together to create a soft, realistic sensation.